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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025
Third SEMESTER
Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG3MDCENG200 - LITERATURE AND KERALA RENAISSANCE
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Part A.

MCQ. Answer all questions. Each question carries **1** mark

1. c). K. Kelappan [K] / [CO1]
2. b). To empower women through recognition of their contributions [U] / [CO1]
3. a). Sahodaran [K] / [CO1]
4. a). The Kayal Sammelanam [K] / [CO1]
5. a). Muthukutty [K] / [CO1]
6. b). He opposed the agricultural labourers' strike [U] / [CO1]
7. c). Advaita Vedanta [K] / [CO1]
8. d). Sadhu Jana ParipalanaSangham [K] / [CO1]
9. b). K. Kelappan [K] / [CO1]
10. a). Vaikom Satyagraha [U] / [CO1]
11. c). The absurdity of caste restrictions and universality of God [U] / [CO1]
12. b. Ramakrishna Pillai [K] / [CO1]
13. d). Unnimishihayude DharmaSabha [U] / [CO1]
14. b). Rev. Joseph Peet [U] / [CO1]
15. b). Inter-caste dining [U] / [CO1]
16. c). Kerala [K] / [CO2]
17. b). Both were equally free [An] / [CO2]
18. b). Compassion and Mercy [U] / [CO2]
19. b). Her memory of the visitors and their details [U] / [CO3]
20. b). 76 [K] / [CO3]

[1x20 = 20]

Part B

SHORT ESSAY.Answer any **6** questions. Each question carries **5** marks

21. [U] / [CO1]

Ezhava Memorial 1896, -- Organised by Travancore EzhavaSabha-- Petition to the King seeking equal opportunities in government jobs and education for the Ezhava community -- Leader - Dr Palpu. Demanded equal access to education and Job opportunity -- Immediate goals were not achieved but raised awareness and inspired later reformers.

22. [U] / [CO2]

1. Caste System: Clothing (Kuberan’s spotless mundu contrasts with the Pulayas’ torn clothes)--and degraded huts.
2. Representation of Woman: - upper-caste (veiling) & lower-caste (enforced exposure)
3. Irrationality: -- Kuberan’s superstition
4. Oppression: -- Reward for violence (Ramankutty’s new mundus) -- normalized brutality. And such other cases.

5. Religion: Use of religion to defend acts of oppression. Role of Christian Mission School and: - Mission school as democratizing knowledge and challenging Brahmin dominance.

   Other relevant points may also be given appropriate marks.

Note: A student who is able to present any three of these ideas effectively deserves full credit

23. [A] / [CO2]

The legal system in Saraswativijayam functions as a key symbol of the new moral and rational order introduced under British colonial rule.- It represents the emerging possibility of justice and reform within a society dominated by caste discrimination and feudal oppression- the legal system is portrayed as an instrument of moral awakening and social correction.- courtroom scene, where the landlord is punished for his unjust treatment of the oppressed, demonstrates how the modern legal system can challenge traditional hierarchies.-Law as a symbol of justice and equality- Representation of gradual social change within the system

24. [A] / [CO2]

Ananda, asks an untouchable woman for water. Society brands the girl as impure. She herself believes she's polluted. The monk is considered pure and spiritual. -- Spiritual transformation -- purity lies not in birth but in thought and compassion. -- Monk calls her "sister". He sees beyond caste barriers. -- Girl whom society sees as impure is spiritually transformed after the interaction --Lord Buddha admitted her into the order of Bhikshunis.

25. [An] / [CO2]

Shock, confusion, and disbelief – never seen such an event at a wedding. -- Some think the groom is arrested for debt – others cry out to God. -- One recalls Kunchu's warning – calls the marriage a bad idea. -- Suggest marrying the girl to Madhavan – shows shifting opinion and emerging reformist thought.

26. [K] / [CO3]

Widower Mother was illiterate. Bhargavi Amma benefited from the establishment of a high school in Kottarakkara due to popular agitation.–Completed education -- Faced restriction from her mother on employment (as she was only allowed to work near home)-- worked as a substitute teacher in various places. -- Retired as an upper primary teacher.

27. [K] / [CO3]

"Paavangal" (Les Miserables), "Indulekha," --works by Pearl S. Buck and Tagore, -- Pride and Prejudice by Jane Austen. She didn't like poetry much.

28. [U] / [CO3]

1. Educational barriers: Women were barred from studying science in Madras University → Mary studied arts despite her ambition to do medicine.
2. Foreign challenges: In UK, she faced racial and cultural isolation. Though she did not write much about such experiences in her memoir, there are two anecdotes: a kid mistook her for a Native American and some other kids called her 'blackie' on a different occasion.
3. In LSM, the chief male doctors questioned Mary's eligibility to be a doctor as the popular belief was that the women's brains were not capable of dealing with such jobs.

29. [U] / [CO3]

There took place a reformist gathering of 40-50 Namboodiris and antharjanams at KanjoorManaMadhom near Mookkuthala Temple. -- Participants discarded traditional customs - antharjanams wore blouses and had shortened earlobes, while Namboodiris cut off kuduma and wore shirts and mundus. -- Young antharjanams secretly read reformist pamphlets written by VT encouraging women to question orthodoxy and seek freedom. – This sparked movements like AntharjanaSamajam; reform leaders such as AryaPallom, ParvathyNenminimangalam, and V.T. Bhattathiripad advanced women's education and social rights, linking Mookkuthala to the broader Kerala Renaissance.

[5x6= 30]